

ENG524 Final-term Current Papers 2026

Short and Long Questions

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SHORT QUESTIONS

1. Types of characters (three types)

Based on commedia dell'arte character classifications, the three main types are:

Vecchi (Old Men) : Pantalone, Dottore – elderly, greedy, foolish authority figures

Zanni (Servants) : Harlequin/Arlecchino, Brighella – cunning, lazy, agile tricksters

Innamorati (Lovers) : Young, romantic, fashionable, often the children of vecchi

2. Kinds of stance (only names)

The stance framework identifies three kinds of stance consequences:

Evaluation – assessing an object

Positioning – positioning the subject (self and others)

Alignment – expressing (dis)alignment with other subjects

3. Three components of stance

Stance is a public act involving:

1. Evaluation – of an object or proposition
2. Positioning – of the speaker/subject and other subjects
3. Alignment – with other subjects in the sociocultural field

4. Covert and overt racism

Overt racism: Explicit, open expressions of racial prejudice, discrimination, or hate speech

Covert racism: Subtle, hidden, or indirect forms of racial discrimination embedded in everyday language and practices

5. Elite and everyday racism

Elite racism: Racism perpetuated through institutional, political, or media discourse by powerful groups; legitimized through elite control of public communication

Everyday racism: Racism experienced in daily interactions and routine social practices, often subtle and normalized

6. Alignment

Alignment refers to the stance-taking act of expressing agreement or shared position with other social subjects. In CDA, it is one of the three consequences of taking a stance—simultaneously evaluating an object, positioning oneself, and aligning with others.

7. Definition of CDA

Critical Discourse Analysis is the application of critical theory to discourse, involving the analysis of texts in their sociocultural context. It distinguishes itself through its inclusion of power as a central analytical lens and moves beyond description to explain social phenomena.

8. Principles of CDA

Fairclough and Wodak (1997) established eight principles:

1. Language is a social practice through which the world is represented
2. Discourse constitutes and is constituted by other social practices
3. Texts acquire meaning through dialectical relationships between texts and social subjects
4. Linguistic features are purposeful, whether conscious or unconscious
5. Power relations are produced, exercised, and reproduced through discourse
6. Speakers/writers operate from specific discursive practices involving inclusions and exclusions
7. Discourse is historical—situated in specific social, cultural, and ideological contexts
8. CDA does not solely interpret texts but also explains them

9. New directions for CDA

New directions include: Social Media CDA (SM-CDA) focusing on digital platforms; Multimodal CDA (MCDA) incorporating images and sound; CDA of film and television; analysis of terrorism/violence discourse; and ethnographic discourse analysis.

10. Three strands similar in media CDA projects

Three shared strands in media CDA projects are:

- Textual analysis – focus on written/spoken language in media
- Discursive practice analysis – examination of production, distribution, and interpretation
- Sociocultural practice analysis – contextual analysis of power and ideology

11. Discursive strategies

Discursive strategies in CDA include mechanisms by which discourse produces, maintains, or challenges social inequalities, including: rationalization, emotionalization, stereotypization, cybertyping, role-playing, crowdsourcing, and counter-reaction.

12. Meta-discourse

Meta-discourse refers to the self-reflective aspects of language—talk about talk. It includes:

- Textual meta-discourse: organizing the text (e.g., "firstly," "in conclusion")
- Interpersonal meta-discourse: engaging with the audience and signaling stance

13. Name three forms of critique

Three forms of critique in CDA:

- Textual critique – analysis of linguistic features and structures
- Discursive critique – analysis of practices of production and interpretation
- Sociocultural critique – analysis of power, ideology, and social context

14. Positive discourse analysis (definition)

Positive Discourse Analysis focuses on analyzing discourses that promote social harmony, peace, resistance, and empowerment—seeking to identify and amplify constructive, inclusive communication rather than solely critiquing dominance and inequality.

15. Definition of FCDA

FCDA (Feminist Critical Discourse Analysis) applies CDA principles with a feminist lens, examining how discourse constructs, reinforces, or challenges gendered power relations and patriarchal ideologies in language and social practices.

16. Five principles of FCDA

Principles of FCDA include analyzing how discourse: constructs gender identities; produces and reproduces gendered power relations; operates ideologically to naturalize patriarchy; is historically situated in gendered contexts; and can be used for feminist resistance and social change.

17. Objectives of FCDA

- Uncover gendered power imbalances in discourse

- Show how language constructs and constrains women's identities and agency
- Challenge patriarchal ideology embedded in texts and talk
- Work toward social transformation through critical analysis

18. Approaches of FCDA

Approaches include: critical discourse analysis with a feminist perspective; post-structuralist discourse analysis; analysis of gendered tropes and representations; and intersectional analysis focusing on how gender intersects with race, class, and other identity markers.

19. CDA and media

CDA applied to media examines how news, advertising, television, and film construct representations of reality, reproduce power relations, and legitimize ideologies through language, images, and sound.

20. CDA and political language

CDA examines political language to uncover how politicians use discourse to: shape public opinion; exercise power and control; legitimize policies; and construct political identities (e.g., Imran Khan's speech study, Labour vs. Conservative discourse).

21. CDA and terrorism/violence

CDA analyzes how terrorism/violence is discursively constructed—examining how media and political discourse label, frame, and legitimize violence, often reinforcing "us vs. them" binaries and serving hegemonic interests.

22. CDA of film

CDA of film analyzes cinematic discourse—examining dialogue, narrative structure, visual elements, and sound to reveal how films construct ideology, represent social groups, and (re)produce power relations.

23. Critical discourse of film (note)

Note: This extends beyond language to include multimodal analysis—how images, music, camera angles, and editing combine with dialogue to produce ideological meanings and position viewers.

24. Television and discourse

CDA examines television as a site of discursive production—analyzing news programs, talk shows, series, and reality TV to identify how televisual discourse constructs social realities, political opinions, and cultural norms.

25. Social media CDA definition (SM-CDA)

Social Media CDA applies CDA frameworks to digital platforms (Facebook, WhatsApp, Twitter, etc.), analyzing user-generated content, platform architectures and affordances, and the role of algorithms in amplifying or suppressing discourse.

26. MCDA definition (Multimodal CDA)

Multimodal CDA extends analysis beyond language to include all semiotic modes: images, sound, color, layout, gestures, and video. It examines how meaning is co-constructed across multiple modes to produce ideology and power effects.

27. Power and media

Media are central to the production and reproduction of power in society. CDA examines how media discourse legitimizes dominant ideologies, controls access to public debate, and shapes public understanding of social issues through selective representation.

28. Importance of journalistic media discourse (three points)

1. Shapes public opinion: Journalistic discourse frames events and issues, influencing how audiences understand the social world
2. Reproduces power relations: News media often legitimize elite perspectives and dominant ideologies

3. Constructs social identities: Journalistic discourse defines and categorizes social groups, places, and events in ways that have real-world consequences

29. Objectives of English/Urdu newspaper

- Inform public about current events and issues
- Represent and construct social, political, and cultural realities
- Serve as sites of ideological production and contestation between different positions

30. Engage Urdu news headlines

This refers to analyzing how Urdu news headlines engage readers through linguistic choices—framing events, presupposing shared knowledge, and constructing particular perspectives.

31. Dawn and New York Times editorial study

This involves comparative CDA of editorial discourse in two major newspapers—examining how they construct political positions, represent international events, and produce ideological meanings within different national contexts.

32. Research description on Dawn and New York

Research comparing these newspapers typically analyzes how they frame global events differently based on national interests, editorial stances, and cultural contexts. Focus includes "Pakistan perspective" and international relations discourse.

33. Ethnographic discourse analysis

Ethnographic discourse analysis combines linguistic analysis with ethnographic fieldwork—studying discourse in natural social contexts, examining how language is embedded in daily practices, cultural norms, and local power relations.

34. Definition of political discourse analysis

Political discourse analysis examines how language is used in political contexts to: exercise power, persuade audiences, construct identities, legitimize policies, and shape public understanding of political issues.

35. Political discourse

Political discourse refers to all forms of language use in political contexts—including speeches, debates, interviews, policy documents, and media commentary—which construct political realities and power relations.

36. How Labour Party differs from Conservative Party

In CDA studies, these parties are analyzed for differences in discursive strategies—framing of economic issues, representations of social welfare, constructions of national identity, and use of metaphor, modality, and evaluation.

37. Political discourse and CDA

CDA applies critical frameworks to political discourse to expose how language serves power—revealing hidden ideologies, manipulation, and the naturalization of political positions as common sense.

38. Imran Khan's speech discursive study

This analyzes Imran Khan's speeches to identify discursive strategies—how he constructs political identity, frames Pakistan's national issues, persuades audiences, and legitimizes his political positions.

39. Definition of neoliberalism

Neoliberalism is a political-economic ideology that emphasizes free markets, privatization, deregulation, and reduced state intervention—discursively constructed as natural and inevitable through policy and media discourse.

40. Jessop's five approaches to neoliberalism

Jessop (2002) identifies five approaches to conceptualizing neoliberalism:

- As a political project
- As a mode of governance
- As a cultural formation
- As an economic strategy
- As a hegemonic discourse

41. Define race (with example)

Race is a socially constructed category based on perceived physical differences (e.g., skin color), used to classify people and justify hierarchies of power and privilege. Example: In colonial discourse, racial categories were produced to legitimize domination.

42. Racism

Racism is a system of domination based on racial categorization, involving: prejudice, discrimination, and exclusion; represented and reproduced through discourse; enacted at both individual (everyday) and institutional (elite) levels.

43. CDA and educational discourse

CDA examines educational discourse—classroom talk, textbooks, curriculum materials, and school policies—to reveal how language constructs knowledge, social identities, and power relations in educational settings.

44. CDA and textbooks

CDA analyzes textbooks to expose how they: represent social groups and historical events; legitimize particular ideologies; construct national identity; and (re)produce social inequalities through language and content.

45. Strengths of textbook CDA (two)

1. Reveals hidden ideologies: Exposes underlying biases, omissions, and power relations in educational materials

2. Promotes critical literacy: Empowers teachers and students to question taken-for-granted representations

46. Discourse in education

Discourse in education includes all language practices in schools—teacher-student interactions, peer talk, written assessments, official policies—which shape learning, identity formation, and social positioning.

47. Discourse historical approach by Wodak (five strategies)

Wodak's Discourse-Historical Approach analyzes five discursive strategies:

- Nomination: How persons, objects, or events are named
- Predication: What characteristics are attributed
- Argumentation: How justifications are constructed
- Perspectivization: How positionality is expressed
- Mitigation/Intensification: How commitment is modulated

48. Border politics

Border politics discourse examines how language constructs and legitimizes territorial boundaries, national identities, migration policies, and inclusion/exclusion of groups—often analyzed through CDA of political speeches and media representation.

49. Violence against women (Clark 1992)

Clark (1992) classified linguistic strategies that mitigate violence against women, including: grammatical agent deletion, nominalization, passive voice, and euphemism—which obscure perpetrator responsibility and normalize violence.

50. For typical tiers of media that CDA should focus on

CDA typically focuses on three tiers of media analysis:

- Text level: Linguistic and multimodal features
- Discursive practice level: Production, distribution, and interpretation
- Sociocultural practice level: Broader social and ideological context

51. Class talk by different linguists

Class talk refers to how social class is constructed and represented in discourse. Different linguists examine how class is enacted through accent, dialect, lexical choices, and interactional styles—often revealing class-based prejudice and inequality.

52. Modal of class (five categories – Savage et al.)

Savage et al.'s (2013) five-class model from the Great British Class Survey:

- Elite
- Established Middle Class
- Technical Middle Class
- New Affluent Workers
- Precariat

53. Subjectivity/Positioning

Positioning theory examines how speakers position themselves and others in discourse—constructing subject positions that carry particular rights, obligations, and social identities. In CDA, positioning reveals how power relations are enacted and contested.

54. Definition of ideology (Althusser)

Althusser defined ideology as a system of representations (images, myths, ideas) through which people experience their relation to social conditions. In CDA, ideology is seen as operating through discourse to naturalize power relations and secure hegemony.

55. What is terrorism?

Terrorism is a contested term—discursively constructed in media and political discourse to label certain acts of violence as illegitimate, often serving to delegitimize particular groups and justify state power.

56. What is reality TV? (brief definition)

Reality TV is a television genre featuring unscripted, real-life situations—constructed and edited for entertainment. CDA examines reality TV discourse for how it normalizes surveillance, constructs moral judgments, and reproduces social hierarchies.

57. Perpetrator mitigation (definition)

Perpetrator mitigation refers to linguistic strategies that obscure or minimize an actor's agency and responsibility for harmful actions—including passive voice, nominalization, and agent deletion.

58. View of Cook on advertising and CDA

Cook (1992) viewed advertising as a powerful discursive genre that constructs consumer identities, naturalizes ideologies of consumption, and blurs boundaries between reality and fantasy—requiring critical analysis to reveal hidden persuasion.

59. Components of literature review

Components of a literature review in CDA research include:

- Introduction to the research topic
- Review of relevant theoretical frameworks
- Review of previous empirical studies
- Identification of gaps or limitations
- Statement of research questions/objectives

60. Pakistan perspective: Bush Administration

This refers to CDA research examining how Pakistan's position in U.S. foreign policy—particularly during the Bush Administration's War on Terror—was constructed in media and political discourse, revealing power asymmetries and national interests.

61. Journalism-related question

Journalism-related CDA questions examine how journalistic practices (news writing, sourcing, framing) construct social realities, reproduce power relations, and serve particular political-economic interests.

62. Name any 5 components while doing research on literature

Components of a literature review in CDA research:

1. Theoretical framework
2. Review of empirical studies
3. Critical synthesis of findings
4. Identification of research gaps
5. Statement of research objectives

63. Pick from 4 statements which aren't a strength of CDA of textbooks

This question asks to identify statements that are NOT recognized strengths of CDA of textbooks. True strengths include: revealing hidden ideologies, promoting critical literacy, exposing bias; weaknesses may include: over-interpretation, failure to account for reader agency, or lack of empirical generalizability.

64. Given 4 statements and find out the strengths of CDA of textbooks

This requires identifying which of four statements accurately describe strengths of CDA of textbooks—recognizing that CDA reveals hidden power relations, biases, and ideological assumptions in educational content.

65. Textbook – statement

66. Define Political discourse analysis

67. Denote modality

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